

PSYA02- Final Exam Preparation

Summer 2026

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Exam Information

- Date & Time: Friday, August 14th from 9:00 am – 11:30 am.
- Location: HL170
- Duration: 2 Hours (120 Minutes)
- Format:
 - 45 Multiple Choice Questions Each Worth 1 Point; Worth a Total of 45 Points
 - 6 Short Answer Questions; Worth a Total of 25 Points
 - Exam will be scored out of a total of 70 Points
- Weight: Worth 45% of Final Grade

Getting Ready for Exam Day

- Please check your final exam seat assignment on Quercus before the exam!
- What To Bring To The Exam:
 - Your Student ID
 - A Pencil
 - An Eraser
 - A Pen
 - No Aids Are Allowed
 - Water in a Clear Bottle
- Get a good night's rest the day before the exam. Cramming for an exam is NOT helpful!
- Make sure you have eaten breakfast prior to the exam.

Study Tips & Tricks

- Review BOTH the lecture content and the textbook readings.
- Practice questions using MindTap and Square Cap.
- Use the Learning Objectives in the textbook and in lecture to guide your studying.
- Attend FSG sessions.
- Make notes (by writing them out!).
- Use the additional resources available on MindTap.
- Create flashcards.
- Try to teach a friend about a concept.
- Use AI appropriately and with discretion as a helpful study tool. Be careful of copyright.

How to Approach Multiple Choice Questions

- Read the question carefully and slowly.
- Highlight or underline key words and/or concepts.
- Try answering the question before looking at the possible answers. Then, check to see if your answer matches one of the possible answers. If it does, you likely have the correct answer!
- If you don't know the answer right away, try putting a  or an  beside each potential answer. This will help you narrow down the options.
- Try to think of concepts holistically and see how they connect to one another. This may help you reason out the answer.
- Never leave anything blank! If after ~2 minutes, you are still stuck, pick your best guess and move onto the next question.
- Fill in the multiple choice scantron as you go! Don't wait until the end to fill it in, in case you run out of time.

Sample Multiple Choice Question

Stanley Milgram conducted an experiment to examine obedience to authority. Which of the following best explains the main conclusions of Milgram's study?

- a. People obey authority only when they believe the authority figure is personally trustworthy.
- ☒ b. Situational factors, such as the presence of a legitimate authority figure, can strongly influence people to obey orders that conflict with their values.
- c. Individuals with aggressive personalities are more likely than others to obey harmful orders.
- d. People refuse to obey authority whenever another person is harmed psychologically.
- e. People refuse to obey authority whenever another person is harmed physically.

Sample Multiple Choice Question

Recall during our Social Psychology lectures, we discussed Zimbardo's Stanford Prison Experiment. Imagine similar studies were being conducted but with different social roles. Based on Zimbardo's findings, which of the following outcomes would be most consistent with the results of the Stanford Prison Experiment?

- ☒ a. Participants randomly assigned to be teachers tend to adopt leadership and mentoring behaviours, while those assigned to be students become more studious.
- ☒ b. Participants randomly assigned to be head chefs tend to behave more authoritatively towards sous chefs, while sous chefs become more likely to follow their direction.
- ☐ c. Participants randomly assigned to be police officers behave more leniently than expected, while participants assigned to be robbers show little change in their behaviour.
- ☒ d. Two of the above are likely.
- ☐ e. All of the above are likely.

How to Approach Short Answer Questions

- Read the question carefully and slowly.
- Highlight or underline key words and/or concepts.
 - Describe: Provide a description.
 - Identify: Name a concept.
 - Define: Provide a definition.
 - Compare: Draw similarities and differences.
- Some questions will include multiple parts. Make sure you answer ALL parts of the question!
- This is your opportunity to demonstrate to your TAs what you have learned! Share your knowledge with them! Remember, the TAs cannot assume you know something. They can only grade what is written in front of them.
- Never leave anything blank! We can't give you part marks if there is nothing written on the sheet!
- Even if you are unsure of the answer, give it your best guess!

Sample Short Answer Question

Please describe Philip Zimbardo's Study. In your answer, please provide a brief overview of the methodology employed, and a summary of the findings. Please also identify and describe the concept that is being studied through this experiment.

Step 1: Read the question slowly and carefully.

Step 2: Highlight and/or underline key concepts and words.

Step 3: Determine what the question is asking you to do.

Step 4: Demonstrate your knowledge by writing a thorough, complete answer.

Sample Short Answer Question

Please describe Philip Zimbardo's Study. In your answer, please provide a brief overview of the methodology employed, and a summary of the findings. Please also identify and describe the concept that is being studied through this experiment.

Zimbardo conducted the Stanford Prison Experiment. In this experiment, undergraduate students were recruited to participate in a study in which they were randomly assigned to be either prison guards or prisoners. The study was designed to last 2 weeks.

Sample Short Answer Question

Please describe Philip Zimbardo's Study. In your answer, please provide a brief overview of the methodology employed, and a summary of the findings. Please also identify and describe the concept that is being studied through this experiment.

Participants became so consumed by their social roles that the experiment needed to end after only a few days due to the terrible abuse of the prisoners by the prison guards.

Sample Short Answer Question

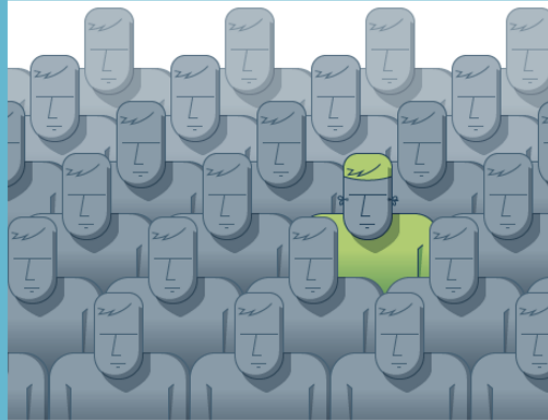
Please describe Philip Zimbardo's Study. In your answer, please provide a brief overview of the methodology employed, and a summary of the findings. Please also identify and describe the concept that is being studied through this experiment.

Zimbardo was interested in examining the impact of social roles on individual's behaviour. Social roles can be defined as the role that an individual has in society (e.g., prison guard versus prisoner).

Summary of Learning Objectives

Lecture 13

Learning Objectives



Behaving Differently in
the Presence of Others

- By the end of class, students should be able to:
 - ...define **social psychology**.
 - ...understand how we interpret the behaviour of other people through:
 - **Attribution Theory**
 - **Fundamental Attribution Error**
 - **Impression Formation**
 - **Self-Fulfilling Prophecy**
 - ...examine how individuals behave in the presence of others.
 - ...define **conformity**, and describe a famous experiment used to examine it.
 - ...define **groupthink**, and describe the impact of group cognition.
 - ...define the **bystander effect**, **diffusion of responsibility** and **pluralistic ignorance**.
 - ...explain how individuals behave as a result of obedience to authority, and identify the factors that affect the level of obedience.
 - ...describe how social roles and situations influence behaviour as shown through the **Stanford Prison Experiment**.

Lectures 14 & 15

Learning Objectives

By the end of class today, students should be able to...

- ...define **reproduction**, and discuss how humans are unique in their approach to reproduction.
- ...describe differences in **mate selectivity** between sexes and genders.
- ... discuss three types of **romantic attraction**, including:
 - **Physical Attraction**
 - **Situational Attraction**
 - **Psychological Attraction**
- ...discuss human susceptibility to **social influence** and review the **hedonic** and **approval** motives.
- ...define **aggression**.
 - ...illustrate the **Frustration–Aggression Hypothesis** with an example.
 - ...discuss some biological and cultural factors that contribute to levels of aggression.
- ...define **prosocial behaviours**, and **altruism**.
 - ...understand the difference between altruism displayed due to **kinship selection** versus **reciprocal altruism**.
- ...define **cooperation**.
 - ...explain how cooperation relates to **group cognition** and explain how group cognition can affect our attitudes and behaviours.

Lecture 16

- By the end of class, students should be able to...
 - Define **psychological disorders** and **abnormal psychology**.
 - Describe the process of diagnosing psychological disorders using the DSM-5.
 - Describe the central features of **anxiety disorders**, and describe the main differences between **generalized anxiety disorder**, **phobic disorders**, and **panic disorder**.
 - Contrast **specific phobias** with **social phobia**, and comment on how **preparedness theory** might apply to phobic disorders.

Learning Objectives

Lecture 17

- By the end of class, students should be able to...
 - ...Compare some varieties of depression, such as **Major Depressive Disorder**, **Dysthymia**, and **Double Depression**.
 - ...Give examples of some biological and experiential factors that increase the risk for depression.
 - ...Describe the **onset**, **prognosis**, **risk factors**, and **comorbidity** profile of **Major Depressive Disorder**.
 - ...Characterize and give an example of **Helplessness Theory**.
 - ...Differentiate **Bipolar Disorder** from Major Depressive Disorder, and discuss biological and psychological factors implicated in Bipolar Disorder.

Daily Objectives

Lecture 18

- By the end of class, students should be able to...
 - ...identify the characteristics of **Obsessive-Compulsive and Related Disorders**, and to examine specific types (**OCD and Hoarding Disorder**).
 - ...identify the characteristics of **Trauma- and Stressor-Related Disorders**, and to examine a specific type (**Posttraumatic Stress Disorder**).
 - ...identify the characteristics of **Substance-Related and Addictive Disorders**, and to examine a specific type (**Gambling Disorder**).
 - ...identify the characteristics of **Neurocognitive Disorders**, and to examine a specific type (**Alzheimer's Disease**).
 - ...identify the characteristics of **Personality Disorders**, and to examine a specific type (**Borderline Personality Disorder**).
 - ...explain the **Biopsychosocial Model**.

Daily Objectives for Today

Lecture 19

By the end of class today, students should be able to...

- ...Understand how to navigate the mental health system.
 - ...Differentiate between the different professionals that treat mental health concerns and identify places in our community to get help.
 - ...Summarize the reasons why it is important to get **treatment**, and why some people do not seek treatment/ have difficulty accessing treatment.
- ...Describe the differing approaches to treatment.
 - ...Explain the basic principles of **Psychoanalysis**, drawing on its origins in the **Psychodynamic Perspective**.
 - ...Explain how **Humanistic** and **Existential Therapies** differ from Psychodynamic Therapy; describe the basic methods of **person-centered therapy**.
 - ...Explain the similarities and differences between **Cognitive Therapies** and **Behaviour Therapies**, and describe the techniques of **cognitive restructuring** and **Cognitive-Behavioural Therapy**.
 - ...Discuss the **ABC Model** for cognitive restructuring.

Daily Objectives for Today

Lecture 20

By the end of class today, students should be able to...

- ...Summarize **pharmaceutical interventions** for psychological disorders (**anti-psychotic**, **anti-anxiety**, and **anti-depressant medications**).
- ...Describe other physiological interventions for mental illness, including **electroconvulsive therapy (ECT)**, **transcranial magnetic stimulation (TMS)**, and **deep brain stimulation (DBS)**.

Daily Objectives for Today

Lecture 22

By the end of class...

- Define stress and stressors.
- Differentiate types of stressors and stress responses.
- Explain how people appraise stress.
- Describe the effects of stressors on mental and physical health.
- Explain how stress contributes to disease.
- Identify strategies to build resilience.



DAILY OBJECTIVES

- ▶ By the end of class today, students should be able to...
 - ▶ ...define the terms **sex** and **gender**, and highlight the differences between these terms.
 - ▶ ...describe gender differences in:
 - ▶ Aggression
 - ▶ Empathy
 - ▶ Sex Drive
 - ▶ ...describe the various possible origins of these gender differences.